

STUDENT BUDGET

Eat well on **R350** a week.

A seven-day South African meal-prep plan built for campus kitchens, shared flats and real-life budgets. One shop, one prep session, food for the whole week.

7 days of food

6 recipes

One 90-minute prep

ZA Local ingredients

±R350

WEEKLY SHOP

21

MEALS COVERED

90 min

SUNDAY PREP

START HERE

Three moves, and the week **cooks itself.**

Nothing here needs a fancy kitchen or a big freezer. One pot, one pan, one oven tray and a few containers will carry the entire plan. Cook the bases once, then spend the week assembling instead of cooking.

1

Shop the list once

Take the list on page 3 to Shoprite, Checkers or Pick n Pay. Buy the cheapest version of every line — house brands are the same food at a lower price.

2

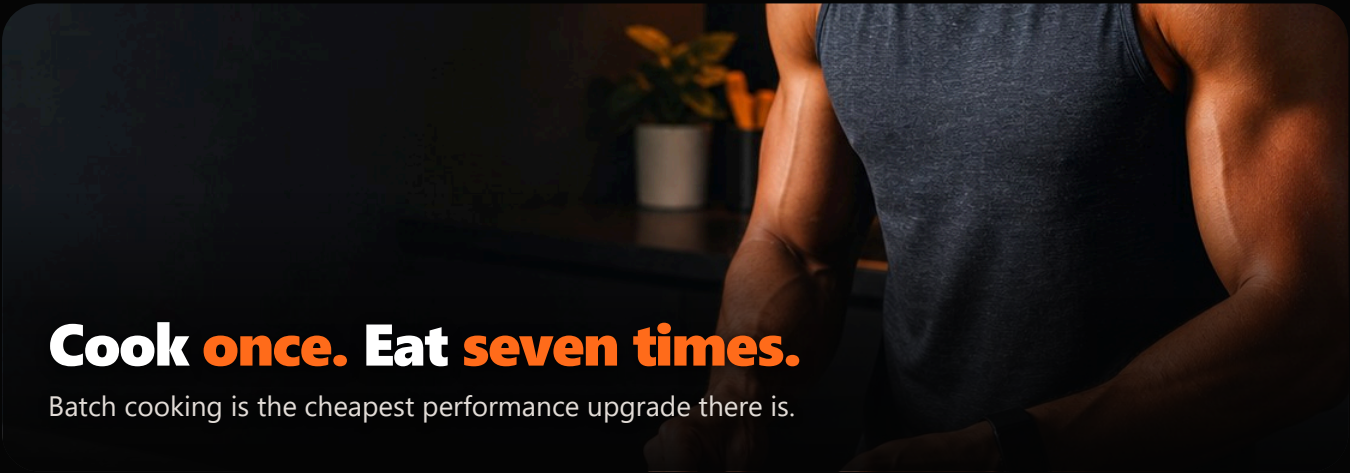
Prep four bases on Sunday

Savoury mince, sugar bean curry, a pot of rice and a tray of egg muffins. Ninety minutes, mostly hands-off, and you have the building blocks for 21 meals.

3

Assemble and log

Each day is a base plus a starch plus vegetables. Log it in FitSocial so you can actually see the week you had — not the week you think you had.



Cook **once.** Eat **seven times.**

Batch cooking is the cheapest performance upgrade there is.

4

BATCH BASES

±R17

PER MEAL

90–130g

PROTEIN / DAY

0

FANCY GEAR

ONE TROLLEY • ONE PERSON • SEVEN DAYS

The R350 list.

Tick as you go. Every line is chosen because it stretches across more than one meal — nothing in this trolley gets used once and forgotten at the back of the cupboard.

CORE SHOP**EST.**

☐ Eggs	18	R58
☐ Chicken portions	1 kg	R75
☐ Chicken livers	500 g	R30
☐ Dried sugar beans	500 g	R25
☐ Rice	2 kg	R45
☐ Oats	1 kg	R38
☐ Cabbage	1 head	R22
☐ Onions	1 kg	R20
☐ Frozen mixed veg	1 kg	R32

Total**±R345****ADD IF THE BUDGET STRETCHES**

+ Bananas 1 kg · R28

+ Milk 2 L · R38

+ Tinned tomato ×3 · R36

+ Peanut butter 400 g · R45

+ Brown bread · R20

ALREADY IN THE CUPBOARD

Cooking oil · salt · pepper · curry powder · mixed herbs · stock cubes · chilli. These are once-off buys that last months — spread them over a few weeks instead of buying them all at once.

SHOP IT ANYWHERE**Pick n Pay**

Prices are typical South African shelf estimates and will vary by store, province and week. Use them to plan the shape of your shop, not as a quote. FitSocial is not affiliated with, endorsed by or sponsored by any retailer shown — the logos are here only to show where the list works.

90 MINUTES · MOSTLY WAITING

The order that keeps you out of the kitchen.

Run these in sequence and the pots do the work while you do something else.

Soak your beans the night before — that single step is what makes the cheapest protein on the list possible.

MINUTE 0 → 10**Beans on, oven on**

Drain the soaked beans, cover with fresh water, bring to the boil, then simmer. Set the oven to 180°C.

MINUTE 10 → 30**Egg muffins in**

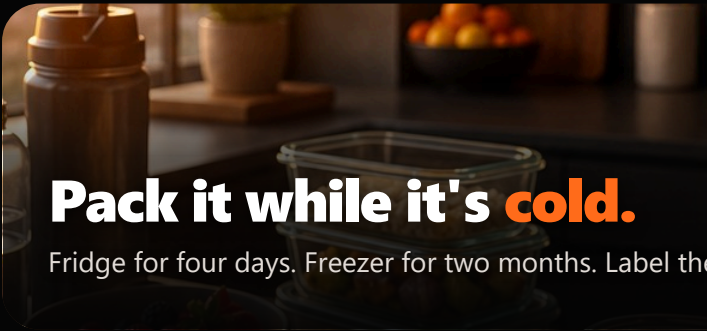
Whisk the eggs with chopped onion and frozen veg, fill a greased muffin tin, bake 20–22 minutes.

MINUTE 30 → 55**Mince and rice**

Brown the onion, add mince and veg, simmer. Rice goes on in a second pot — cook the full 2 kg bag over the week, not all at once.

MINUTE 55 → 90**Curry, cool, pack**

Finish the bean curry, then cool everything uncovered for 20 minutes before it goes into containers. Warm food in a sealed tub is how leftovers go wrong.



Pack it while it's cold.

Fridge for four days. Freezer for two months. Label the lid with the date.

THE WEEK, ASSEMBLED**Mon** Oats · muffins + fruit · mince & rice**Tue** Oats · bean curry & rice · livers**Wed** Muffins · mince & cabbage · lentil stew**Thu** Oats · bean curry · chicken & rice**Fri** Muffins · mince & rice · chicken**Sat/Sun** Freezer picks & leftovers

Mornings, **solved** the night before.

BREAKFAST

01



Peanut Butter & Banana Overnight Oats

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	TIME
420 kcal	16 g	5 min

YOU NEED • 1 SERVING

- 60 g oats
- 150 ml milk (or water)
- 1 tbsp peanut butter
- 1 banana, sliced
- Pinch of cinnamon

METHOD

1. Stir the oats and milk together in a jar or tub until every oat is wet.
2. Swirl the peanut butter through — don't fully mix it, you want pockets.
3. Seal and leave in the fridge overnight.
4. Top with banana and cinnamon in the morning.

Prep tip: Build four jars at once on Sunday. They keep four days; add the banana on the day.

FREEZER READY

02



Chakalaka Egg & Veg Muffins

PER 1 MUFFIN	PROTEIN	TIME
180 kcal	16 g	30 min

YOU NEED • 12 MUFFINS

- 12 eggs
- 1 tin chakalaka (or 2 cups frozen mixed veg)
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- Salt, pepper, pinch of chilli
- Oil for greasing

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 180°C and grease a 12-hole muffin tin well.
2. Whisk the eggs, then stir in the chakalaka, onion and seasoning.
3. Divide between the holes — fill each about three-quarters.
4. Bake 20–22 minutes until set and just golden. Cool in the tin.

Prep tip: Freeze flat on a tray, then bag them. Microwave 45 seconds from frozen.

Two pots that become **ten meals**.



Freezer Savoury Mince

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
300 kcal	26 g	6

YOU NEED • 6 SERVINGS

- 500 g lean beef mince
- 1 onion + 2 carrots, diced
- 2 cups frozen mixed veg
- 1 tin chopped tomato
- 1 stock cube, 1 tsp mixed herbs

METHOD

1. Brown the onion and carrot in a little oil, 5 minutes.
2. Add the mince and break it up until no pink is left.
3. Stir in tomato, stock cube, herbs and a splash of water.
4. Simmer 20 minutes, then fold the frozen veg through for the last 5.

Prep tip: This is the most flexible thing you'll cook — serve over rice, in a wrap, or on cabbage.



Sugar Bean & Veg Curry

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
340 kcal	16 g	6

YOU NEED • 6 SERVINGS

- 500 g dried sugar beans, soaked overnight
- 1 onion, 2 carrots, ½ cabbage
- 1 tin chopped tomato
- 2 tbsp curry powder, 1 stock cube
- Rice, to serve

METHOD

1. Drain the soaked beans, cover with fresh water and simmer 50–60 min until soft.
2. In a second pot, fry the onion, then the curry powder for 30 seconds.
3. Add carrots, tomato and stock cube; simmer 10 minutes.
4. Stir in the beans and shredded cabbage; simmer 10 more.

Prep tip: Soaking is non-negotiable — it halves the cooking time and the gas bill.

Cheap protein that still **tastes like dinner.**

BUDGET FUEL

05



Peri-Peri Chicken Livers & Rice

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	TIME
400 kcal	34 g	25 min

YOU NEED • 3 SERVINGS

- 500 g chicken livers, trimmed
- 1 onion + 1 green pepper, sliced
- 1 tin chopped tomato
- 2 tsp peri-peri or chilli, 1 tsp paprika
- 1½ cups cooked rice

METHOD

1. Rinse the livers well and pat dry — this is what keeps them mild.
2. Fry the onion and pepper 4 minutes, add the spices for 30 seconds.
3. Add the livers and sear 4–5 minutes, turning once.
4. Pour in the tomato and simmer 8 minutes. Serve over rice.

Why it's here: Gram for gram, the cheapest complete protein in the store.

FREEZER READY

06



Lentil & Butternut Potjie Stew

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
330 kcal	18 g	6

YOU NEED • 6 SERVINGS

- 2 cups brown lentils, rinsed
- 500 g butternut, cubed
- 1 onion, 2 carrots, 2 bay leaves
- 1 tin chopped tomato, 2 stock cubes
- 1 tbsp curry powder

METHOD

1. Fry the onion and carrot until soft, then stir in the curry powder.
2. Add lentils, tomato, stock cubes, bay leaves and 4 cups of water.
3. Simmer 25 minutes, stirring now and then so it doesn't catch.
4. Add the butternut and cook 15–20 more, until it just holds its shape.

Prep tip: Freezes better than almost anything. Portion it hot, cool it fast, freeze it flat.

SWAPS, STORAGE AND STAYING HONEST

Cheaper, longer, better.

Nothing on this plan is precious. Swap for whatever is on special this week — the structure is what makes it work, not the specific ingredients.

IF IT'S EXPENSIVE, SWAP IT

Beef mince → soya mince, lentils, chicken livers

Chicken breast → portions, thighs, drumsticks

Fresh veg → frozen mixed veg (same nutrition)

Milk → long-life or milk powder

Sugar beans → lentils, split peas, tinned baked beans

HOW LONG IT KEEPS

Cooked rice 3 days fridge · 1 month freezer

Mince & stews 4 days fridge · 2 months freezer

Egg muffins 4 days fridge · 2 months freezer

Overnight oats 4 days fridge · don't freeze

Cooked chicken 3 days fridge · 2 months freezer

FIVE HABITS THAT SAVE MORE THAN THE COUPONS

01 Shop with the list, never hungry

02 Buy house brands by default

03 Cook the starch in bulk, portion it cold

04 Freeze flat — it stacks and thaws faster

05 Eat the fridge before you shop again

4 days

FRIDGE RULE

2 months

FREEZER RULE

<2 hrs

**COOL BEFORE
SEALING**

Label it

NAME + DATE

This guide is general nutrition information for healthy adults, not medical or dietetic advice. If you are pregnant, managing a health condition, or working with a dietitian, check with them before changing how you eat.

THE PLAN IS THE EASY PART

Now **track it** and watch it stick.

A plan you follow for three days is a nice PDF. A plan you can see yourself following for three months is a habit. Log your meals, your macros and your sessions in FitSocial — and let your circle keep you honest.



Scan to get early access

fitsocial.co.za

FitSocial launches on Android and iOS. Join the waitlist to get your invite before the public launch — founding members get free early access, locked-in founding pricing and a say in the roadmap.

- ✓ Log meals and macros in seconds
- ✓ Track workouts, runs and streaks
- ✓ Share progress with your circle
- ✓ Build South African grocery plans
- ✓ See weekly trends, not single days
- ✓ Free core logging, always